

Brainstorming & Ideation Phase

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Item	Detail
Project	Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Platform	ServiceNow (Flow Designer, Service Catalog)
Phase	1 - Brainstorming & Ideation
Purpose	Understand the problem, explore options and select the approach.

1. Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Standard laptops need configuration when they arrive, but this step is prone to oversight or delay. This frustrates users and leads to inefficient use of IT department resources.

2. Who Is Affected

Group	Impact today
End users	Wait longer than necessary for a configured laptop; no visibility of progress.
IT procurement team	Manually chase configuration once the laptop is ordered or received.
Hardware team	Configuration work arrives late, informally or not at all.
IT management	Poor use of staff time and inconsistent service levels.

3. Pain Points

- The configuration step depends on someone remembering to raise it.
- Manual hand-offs create delays and room for error.
- Work is not routed to the Hardware team in a consistent way.
- Users get frustrated when laptops are not ready on arrival.

4. How Might We...

How might we make sure every approved Standard Laptop request automatically creates a configuration task for the Hardware team, with no manual follow-up?

5. Ideas Explored

Idea	Pros	Cons	Decision
Email reminders to Hardware team	Very simple	Still manual; easy to miss; no tracking	Rejected
Flow Designer flow on the catalog item	Low-code, visual, native to ServiceNow, easy to maintain	Needs a flow to be built and attached to the item	Selected

Idea	Pros	Cons	Decision
Legacy Workflow Editor	Works on catalog items	Older approach; Flow Designer is the current tool	Rejected
Scripted business rules	Full control; easy to import as scripts	Code to maintain	Fallback (provided as scripts)
Spreadsheet tracker	No development	Outside ServiceNow; no automation	Rejected

6. Selected Idea

Build a Flow Designer flow named **Standard Laptop Task**. When a Standard Laptop request is placed and approved, the flow creates a Catalog Task, sets its short description to *Laptop needs to be configured* and assigns it to the **Hardware** group. The flow is attached to the Standard Laptop catalog item so it runs automatically.

7. Expected Outcomes

- A seamless experience for users, with laptops configured on time.
- Less manual intervention and fewer errors.
- Better use of IT department resources through automatic task allocation.
- Higher overall efficiency of IT procurement operations.

8. Proposed Success Measures

Measure	Target
Approved Standard Laptop requests that get a configuration task	100%
Time from approval to task creation	Immediate (automatic)
Manual steps needed to raise the task	None